NJL Enterprises: Employee Handbook

Version: 2026.1

Status: Internal Use Only

Table of Contents

1. Introduction & Mission

- **1.1 Welcome Message from the CEO**
- **1.2 Our History (Founded 2012)**
- **1.3 Mission Statement**
- **1.4 Our Core Values (The "Three Is")**
- **1.5 Purpose of this Handbook**

2. Code of Conduct & Ethics

- **2.1 Professionalism & Dress Code**
- **2.2 Conflict of Interest & Financial Disclosures**
- **2.3 Gifts and Entertainment ($50 Limit)**
- **2.4 Confidentiality & Data Privacy**
- **2.5 Use of Company Resources**
- **2.6 Whistleblower Policy (1-800-NJL-SAFE)**

3. Work Schedules & Attendance

- **3.1 Standard Workweek & Core Hours (10 AM – 3 PM)**
- **3.2 Hybrid Work Model (The "3-2 Model")**
- **3.3 Attendance & Notification Protocols**
- **3.4 Flexible Scheduling (FlexTime)**
- **3.5 Inclement Weather & Office Closures**

4. Compensation & Payroll

- **4.1 Pay Cycles & Distribution (Bi-Weekly)**

- **4.2 Employment Classifications (Exempt vs. Non-Exempt)**
- **4.3 Overtime Policy ($1.5x and $2.0x Rates)**
- **4.4 Salary Reviews & Adjustments**
- **4.5 Payroll Deductions (Mandatory vs. Voluntary)**
- **4.6 Garnishments**

5. Benefits & Healthcare

- **5.1 Medical Insurance Tiers (Standard, HDHP, Premier Gold)**
- **5.2 Dental and Vision Coverage**
- **5.3 Retirement Savings (401k) & Vesting Schedule**
- **5.4 Life and Disability Insurance**
- **5.5 Wellness & Mental Health (EAP)**
- **5.6 Tuition Assistance Program**

6. Leave Policies (PTO)

- **6.1 Vacation and Personal Leave Accrual**
- **6.2 Sick Leave & Documentation**
- **6.3 Paid Parental Leave (12 Weeks)**
- **6.4 Bereavement Leave**
- **6.5 Jury Duty and Voting**
- **6.6 Family and Medical Leave (FMLA)**

7. Technology & Security

- **7.1 Hardware Provisioning & Maintenance**
- **7.2 Software Installation & Licensing**
- **7.3 Password Policy & Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)**
- **7.4 Network Access & VPN (GlobalProtect)**
- **7.5 Data Classification (Public, Internal, Restricted)**
- **7.6 Reporting Security Incidents**

8. Workplace Safety & Health

- **8.1 General Safety Standards & Ergonomics**
- **8.2 Reporting Accidents & Near-Misses (Form SF-101)**
- **8.3 Emergency Procedures & Assembly Points**
- **8.4 Drug-Free Workplace & Testing**
- **8.5 Workplace Violence Prevention**

9. Performance Reviews & Development

- **9.1 The Performance Cycle (July & December)**
- **9.2 Performance Ratings (1–5 Scale)**
- **9.3 Professional Development Fund ($1,500 Stipend)**
- **9.4 Internal Mobility & Promotions**
- **9.5 Performance Improvement Plans (PIP)**

10. Termination & Resignation

- **10.1 Voluntary Resignation (Notice Periods)**
- **10.2 Involuntary Termination (Gross Misconduct)**
- **10.3 The Offboarding Process & Equipment Return**
- **10.4 Final Compensation & PTO Payout (80 Hour Cap)**
- **10.5 Post-Employment Obligations (NDA)**

11. Travel & Expense (T&E) Policy

- **11.1 Air Travel & Lodging (City Tiers & Flight Class)**
- **11.2 Meals and Incidental Expenses (Per Diem)**
- **11.3 Ground Transportation (Mileage & Ride-Share)**
- **11.4 Expense Reporting (Expensify & Receipt Rules)**
- **11.5 Non-Reimbursable Items**

Section 1: Introduction & Mission

Welcome to **NJL Enterprises**. We are thrilled to have you join a team that is redefining the future of global commerce. This section outlines who we are, where we came from, and the principles that guide our daily operations.

1.1 Welcome Message from the CEO

"At NJL Enterprises, we believe that the complexity of the modern world requires elegant, automated solutions. You were hired because we see in you the capability to challenge the status quo and the integrity to do it responsibly. Welcome to the frontier of logistics." — *Nathaniel J. Lang, Founder & CEO*

1.2 Our History

Founded in **2012** in a small tech incubator in Chicago, NJL Enterprises began as a software-as-a-service (SaaS) provider for local courier fleets. Over the last decade, we have expanded into a global powerhouse, managing automated sea-freight systems, AI-driven warehousing, and sustainable "last-mile" delivery robotics. Today, we operate in 14 countries with over 5,000 employees worldwide.

1.3 Mission Statement

To bridge the gap between global production and local consumption through **autonomous, carbon-neutral logistics networks** that empower businesses of all sizes to compete in a global marketplace.

1.4 Our Core Values (The "Three Is")

Our culture is built on three foundational pillars. Every decision made at NJL—from engineering to HR—should reflect these values:

- **Integrity:** We do what is right, even when no one is watching. We are transparent with our data, our failures, and our successes.
- **Innovation:** We don't just optimize existing paths; we build new ones. We encourage "calculated moonshots" and value creative problem-solving.
- **Interconnectivity:** We recognize that our success is tied to the success of our partners, our environment, and our fellow team members. No department is an island.

1.5 Purpose of this Handbook

This handbook is designed to be a living document. It serves as a roadmap for your professional journey here, providing the "rules of the road" regarding your benefits, responsibilities, and the resources available to help you succeed.

Section 2: Code of Conduct & Ethics

This section defines the standard of behavior expected from every employee at **NJL Enterprises**. Our reputation is built on the collective actions of our team; therefore, we hold ourselves to the highest ethical standards.

2.1 Professionalism & Workplace Decorum

NJL Enterprises fosters a workplace of mutual respect. Professionalism extends beyond job performance to include how we interact with colleagues, clients, and partners.

- **Interpersonal Conduct:** We maintain a "Zero Tolerance" policy for harassment, bullying, or discriminatory behavior.
- **Dress Code:** Our standard is **Business Casual** (Monday–Thursday).
    - **Permitted:** Slacks, chinos, blouses, polo shirts, and sweaters.
    - **Casual Fridays:** Clean, non-distressed denim is permitted.
    - **Prohibited:** Gym wear, flip-flops, or clothing with offensive graphics/slogans.

2.2 Conflict of Interest

Employees must avoid any situation where their personal interests interfere—or appear to interfere—with the interests of NJL Enterprises.

- **Outside Employment:** Employees may hold outside jobs provided they do not compete with NJL or interfere with the employee's performance.
- **Financial Interests:** Employees must disclose if they (or an immediate family member) hold a financial stake of **5% or more** in any competitor, vendor, or client of NJL.
- **Disclosure:** Potential conflicts must be reported via the **Internal Ethics Portal** within 10 business days of the conflict arising.

2.3 Gifts and Entertainment

To maintain objectivity in our business relationships, employees must follow these guidelines regarding gifts:

- **Nominal Gifts:** Employees may accept items of "nominal value" (e.g., pens, mugs, or calendars) valued at **less than $50**.
- **Prohibited:** Cash, gift cards, or lavish entertainment (e.g., sporting event suites or luxury travel) from vendors or clients are strictly forbidden.
- **Reporting:** Any gift valued over $50 must be reported to the Compliance Department using **Form G-2**.

2.4 Confidentiality & Data Privacy

As a logistics and tech firm, our data is our most valuable asset.

- **Proprietary Information:** This includes client lists, software code, logistics algorithms, and unannounced financial results.
- **Non-Disclosure:** Employees are bound by the Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA) signed during onboarding, which remains in effect even after employment ends.
- **Privacy:** Employees must handle all personal data of colleagues and customers in accordance with global privacy laws (GDPR/CCPA).

2.5 Use of Company Resources

Company equipment, including laptops, mobile phones, and internet access, is provided for business purposes.

- **Incidental Use:** Brief personal use of email or the internet is permitted as long as it does not interfere with productivity.
- **Prohibited Content:** Accessing illegal, sexually explicit, or hate-oriented material on company devices is grounds for immediate termination.

2.6 Whistleblower Policy

NJL Enterprises encourages employees to report unethical behavior without fear of retaliation.

- **Reporting Channels:** Reports can be made to a direct supervisor, HR, or via the **Anonymous Ethics Hotline at 1-800-NJL-SAFE**.
- **Non-Retaliation:** NJL strictly prohibits retaliation against any employee who makes a good-faith report of a suspected violation.

Section 3: Work Schedules & Attendance

NJL Enterprises recognizes the importance of flexibility in the modern workplace while maintaining the collaborative energy of in-person interaction. This section defines how we manage our time and presence to ensure maximum productivity across global time zones.

3.1 Standard Workweek and Core Hours

The standard workweek for full-time employees consists of 40 hours, typically distributed over five days, Monday through Friday. To ensure synchronous collaboration across departments, NJL observes Core Hours:

Core Hours: 10:00 AM – 3:00 PM (Local Time).

All employees are expected to be available for internal meetings and collaborative sessions during these hours, regardless of their physical location.

Meal Periods: Employees are entitled to a 60-minute unpaid meal break daily, which should generally be taken outside of Core Hours if possible.

3.2 Hybrid Work Model (The "3-2 Model")

NJL Enterprises utilizes a hybrid work structure designed to balance personal flexibility with team cohesion.

In-Office Days: Employees are required to be in the office three days per week.

Fixed Days: Tuesday and Wednesday are mandatory "Anchor Days" for all staff to facilitate all-hands meetings and cross-departmental syncs.

Flex Day: The third day is a "Rotating Day" chosen by the Department Head to suit specific team needs.

Remote Days: Monday and Friday are "Remote-Optional" days. Employees may work from home or the office.

Eligibility: New hires must work 100% on-site during their initial 90-day probationary period to ensure proper onboarding and mentorship.

3.3 Attendance and Notification

Reliability is key to our logistics-driven mission.

Punctuality: Employees are expected to be ready to begin work at the start of their scheduled shift.

Unplanned Absence: In the event of illness or emergency, employees must notify their direct supervisor via Slack or Email at least 30 minutes prior to their scheduled start time.

Job Abandonment: Failure to report to work or notify a supervisor for three consecutive business days will be considered a voluntary resignation (job abandonment).

3.4 Flexible Scheduling ("FlexTime")

We understand that life happens. Employees may request a permanent shift in their start/end times (e.g., 7:00 AM – 4:00 PM) provided:

The schedule still covers the Core Hours (10 AM – 3 PM).

The request is submitted in writing and approved by both the Department Manager and HR.

Performance remains at or above "Meets Expectations."

3.5 Inclement Weather and Office Closures

As a logistics company, we monitor weather patterns closely.

Physical Office Closure: If a physical office is closed due to weather, employees who can work remotely are expected to do so.

Emergency Pay: If an office is closed and an employee's role cannot be performed remotely (e.g., Warehouse/Loading staff), they will receive "Emergency Closure Pay" for their scheduled hours.

Section 4: Compensation & Payroll

NJL Enterprises is committed to providing a fair, transparent, and competitive compensation structure. We believe in rewarding high performance while ensuring internal equity and compliance with all regional labor laws.

4.1 Pay Cycles and Distribution

To ensure consistency for our employees' financial planning, NJL operates on a standard bi-weekly schedule.

- **Pay Frequency:** Employees are paid every other Friday.
- **Pay Period:** Each paycheck covers the two-week work period ending on the Friday of the previous week.
- **Payment Method:** Direct Deposit is the mandatory method of payment. Employees must provide valid banking information via the **WorkReady Employee Portal**. Changes to banking details must be submitted at least **seven business days** prior to the next pay date.

4.2 Employment Classifications

NJL classifies employees based on job responsibilities and eligibility for overtime under the Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA) or local equivalent:

- **Exempt Employees:** Generally professional, executive, or administrative staff paid on a salary basis. Exempt employees are not eligible for overtime pay.

- **Non-Exempt Employees:** Typically hourly or certain salaried staff who are eligible for overtime pay for hours worked beyond the standard workweek.

4.3 Overtime Policy

While we strive to manage workloads within standard hours, operational needs may occasionally require extra time.

- **Eligibility:** Only **Non-Exempt** employees receive overtime pay.
- **Rate:** Overtime is paid at **$1.5\times$ (time-and-a-half)** the employee's regular hourly rate for all hours worked in excess of 40 within a single workweek (Monday–Sunday).
- **Approval:** All overtime must be pre-approved in writing by a Department Head. Unauthorized overtime may result in disciplinary action.
- **Holidays:** Hours worked on a "Company Recognized Holiday" are paid at a premium rate of **$2.0\times$ (double time)** for all staff.

4.4 Salary Reviews and Adjustments

NJL conducts regular market analysis to ensure our pay scales remain competitive.

- **Annual Merit Increases:** Based on the December Performance Review, employees may be eligible for a merit-based salary increase effective the first pay period of the New Year.
- **Promotion Increases:** Adjustments following a promotion to a higher "Job Level" (e.g., Level 2 to Level 3) take effect on the first day of the new role.
- **Cost of Living Adjustments (COLA):** At the discretion of the Board, a company-wide COLA may be applied during periods of significant inflation.

4.5 Payroll Deductions

NJL is required by law to withhold specific deductions from every paycheck.

- **Mandatory:** Federal, state, and local income taxes, as well as Social Security and Medicare (FICA) contributions.
- **Voluntary:** Health insurance premiums, 401(k) contributions, Life Insurance buy-ups, and HSA/FSA allocations as selected by the employee during Open Enrollment.

4.6 Garnishments

NJL Enterprises complies with all court-ordered wage garnishments (e.g., child support, tax levies, or student loans). Employees will be notified by the Payroll Department upon receipt of a legal garnishment order.

Section 5: Benefits & Healthcare

NJL Enterprises provides a comprehensive benefits package designed to support the physical, mental, and financial well-being of our employees and their families. Eligibility for full benefits begins on the **first day of the month following 30 days of continuous employment**.

5.1 Medical Insurance Plans

We partner with **BlueHorizon Health** to offer three distinct medical tiers. Employees may select the plan that best fits their household needs during the annual Open Enrollment period (November 1–15).

Feature	Standard PPO	High-Deductible (HDHP)	Premier Gold
Annual Deductible	$1,000 Individual / $2,000 Family	$3,000 Individual / $6,000 Family	$0
PCP Copay	$40	20% after deductible	$15
Specialist Copay	$60	20% after deductible	$25
Out-of-Pocket Max	$4,000	$6,500	$2,000
HSA Eligible?	No	Yes (with NJL Match)	No

- **NJL Health Savings Account (HSA) Contribution:** For employees enrolled in the HDHP, NJL will contribute **$500 annually** (prorated by start date) to your HSA to help cover deductible costs.

5.2 Dental and Vision Coverage

- **Dental:** Covers two cleanings per year at 100%. Orthodontics are covered at 50% up to a lifetime maximum of $2,500 per dependent.

- **Vision:** Provided through **ClearSight Network**. Includes one eye exam per year ($10 copay) and a $200 allowance for frames or contact lenses every 12 months.

5.3 Retirement Savings (401k)

NJL Enterprises encourages long-term financial planning through our 401(k) plan managed by **Vanguard**.

- **Company Match:** NJL matches **100% of the first 3%** of your gross salary contributions, and **50% of the next 2%**.
    - *Example: If you contribute 5%, NJL contributes 4%.*
- **Vesting Schedule:** While your own contributions are always 100% yours, the company-matched funds vest over a four-year period:
    - **Year 1:** 25% vested
    - **Year 2:** 50% vested
    - **Year 3:** 75% vested
    - **Year 4:** 100% vested (Fully Vested)

5.4 Life and Disability Insurance

- **Basic Life Insurance:** NJL provides life insurance at no cost to the employee, valued at **2x the employee's annual salary**.
- **Short-Term Disability (STD):** Covers 60% of base pay for up to 12 weeks for non-work-related illness or injury.
- **Long-Term Disability (LTD):** Kicks in after 90 days of disability, covering 50% of base pay until age 65 or recovery.

5.5 Wellness and Mental Health

- **Employee Assistance Program (EAP):** Provides 6 free confidential counseling sessions per year for employees and their household members.
- **Fitness Reimbursement:** NJL will reimburse up to **$50 per month** for gym memberships, yoga classes, or mental health app subscriptions (e.g., Calm or Headspace).

5.6 Tuition Assistance

After one year of service, employees are eligible for tuition reimbursement for degree programs related to their current role or a future career path at NJL. The maximum reimbursement is **$5,250 per calendar year**.

Section 6: Leave Policies (PTO)

NJL Enterprises recognizes that rest and recovery are essential to a sustainable career. Our Paid Time Off (PTO) policy is designed to be flexible, combining vacation, personal time, and incidental needs into a single bank of hours.

6.1 Vacation and Personal Leave (PTO)

PTO is accrued on a per-pay-period basis. The rate of accrual is determined by the employee's continuous years of service with NJL Enterprises.

Years of Service	Annual Accrual	Accrual Per Pay Period	Max Carryover (Dec 31)
0–2 Years	15 Days (120 Hours)	4.62 Hours	40 Hours
3–5 Years	20 Days (160 Hours)	6.15 Hours	80 Hours
5+ Years	25 Days (200 Hours)	7.69 Hours	120 Hours

- **Carryover Policy:** Employees are encouraged to use their PTO during the calendar year. Hours exceeding the "Max Carryover" limit on December 31st will be forfeited ("Use it or Lose it").
- **Requesting Leave:** PTO requests must be submitted via the **WorkReady Portal** at least **two weeks in advance** for any absence exceeding two consecutive days.

6.2 Sick Leave

In addition to standard PTO, NJL provides **10 days (80 hours) of Paid Sick Leave** per calendar year.

- **Usage:** Sick leave may be used for the employee’s own illness, medical appointments, or to care for an ill family member.
- **Documentation:** A healthcare provider’s note is required for absences exceeding **three consecutive scheduled workdays**.
- **Payout:** Unlike PTO, unused sick leave is **not** paid out upon termination of employment.

6.3 Parental Leave

NJL Enterprises is proud to support growing families. We provide **12 weeks of 100% paid parental leave** to all full-time employees following the birth, adoption, or foster placement of a child.

- **Eligibility:** Employees must have completed **six months** of continuous service.
- **Usage:** Leave must be taken within the first 12 months of the qualifying event and can be taken intermittently with prior Manager and HR approval.

6.4 Bereavement Leave

Employees are granted up to **5 days of paid leave** for the death of an immediate family member (spouse, domestic partner, child, parent, or sibling) and **2 days** for extended family members.

6.5 Jury Duty and Voting

- **Jury Duty:** NJL provides full pay for the duration of jury service. Employees must provide a copy of the jury summons to HR and are expected to return to work if released from jury duty during their standard work hours.
- **Voting:** If an employee's work schedule does not allow for three consecutive non-working hours while polls are open, NJL provides up to **2 hours of paid time off** to vote in local, state, or federal elections.

6.6 Leave of Absence (FMLA)

NJL complies with the Family and Medical Leave Act (FMLA), providing up to 12 weeks of **unpaid**, job-protected leave for specified family and medical reasons for eligible employees.

Section 7: Technology & Security

As a data-driven logistics firm, the security of our digital infrastructure is paramount. This section outlines the responsibilities of every employee in protecting **NJL Enterprises'** intellectual property, client data, and physical hardware.

7.1 Hardware Provisioning and Maintenance

NJL provides the necessary computing power for your role.

- **Standard Issue:** All office-based and remote employees are issued a corporate laptop (Apple MacBook Pro or Dell XPS) and necessary peripherals.
- **Ownership:** All hardware provided by the company remains the sole property of NJL Enterprises.
- **Loss or Damage:** Any loss, theft, or significant damage to company hardware must be reported to the **IT Asset Management Team** within **4 hours** of the incident. In cases of theft, a police report is required for insurance purposes.

7.2 Software Installation and Licensing

To prevent security vulnerabilities and ensure legal compliance:

- **Approved Software:** Employees may only install software available through the **"NJL App Self-Service"** portal.
- **Prohibited Software:** The installation of peer-to-peer (P2P) file-sharing software, unauthorized VPNs, or unapproved messaging platforms is strictly prohibited.
- **Requests:** If your role requires specialized software not found in the portal, a ticket must be submitted to IT Support with a brief business justification.

7.3 Password and Authentication Policy

NJL utilizes a **"Zero Trust"** security architecture.

- **Complexity:** Passwords must be a minimum of **14 characters** and include a combination of uppercase letters, lowercase letters, numbers, and special characters.
- **Rotation:** Corporate passwords must be changed every **90 days**.
- **Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA):** Use of the **Duo Security** app is mandatory for all system logins. Sharing or "tapping" to approve an MFA request you did not initiate is a terminable offense.
- **Password Managers:** Use of the corporate-provided **KeyGuard** account is mandatory for storing any work-related credentials.

7.4 Network Access and VPN

- **Internal Network:** While in-office, employees should connect to the "NJL-Secure" Wi-Fi network.

- **Remote Work:** When working from home or a public location (e.g., coffee shop), employees must use the **NJL GlobalProtect VPN** to access any internal systems or client data. Use of public, unencrypted Wi-Fi without a VPN is strictly prohibited.

7.5 Data Classification and Handling

Not all data is created equal. Employees must categorize information into one of three tiers:

1. **Public:** General marketing materials and public press releases.
2. **Internal:** Internal memos, project timelines, and standard operating procedures.
3. **Restricted:** Client PII (Personally Identifiable Information), trade secrets, algorithms, and financial projections. **Restricted** data must never be stored on local drives and must be encrypted if sent via email.

7.6 Reporting Security Incidents

If you suspect a security breach—including receiving a suspicious "Phishing" email or noticing unauthorized access to your account:

- **Immediate Action:** Do not click links or attempt to "investigate" yourself.
- **Reporting:** Click the **"Report Phish"** button in Outlook or Slack, or email security-incident@njl.com immediately.

Section 8: Workplace Safety & Health

NJL Enterprises is committed to providing a safe and healthy work environment for all employees, contractors, and visitors. Because our operations span corporate offices and automated fulfillment centers, safety is a shared responsibility that requires constant vigilance.

8.1 General Safety Standards

All employees are expected to follow safety guidelines and remain alert to potential hazards.

- **Housekeeping:** Keep work areas, aisles, and emergency exits clear of debris, cables, and obstructions.

- **Ergonomics:** NJL provides adjustable desks and ergonomic chairs. Employees are encouraged to request an "Ergonomic Assessment" from HR if they experience physical discomfort related to their workstation setup.
- **Lifting Technique:** When moving packages or equipment, use the "legs, not back" method. For items exceeding **40 lbs**, team lifting or the use of a mechanical dolly is mandatory.

8.2 Reporting Accidents and "Near-Misses"

We maintain a "No-Blame" reporting culture to prevent future accidents.

- **Immediate Reporting:** Any workplace injury, regardless of severity, must be reported to your supervisor and the Safety Officer within **24 hours**.
- **Form SF-101:** Employees must complete the **Workplace Incident Report (Form SF-101)** to document the event.
- **Near-Misses:** A "Near-Miss" is an unplanned event that did not result in injury but had the potential to do so. These must be reported via the Slack channel #safety-first.

8.3 Emergency Procedures

In the event of an emergency (fire, gas leak, or structural threat), employees must follow the evacuation plan posted near every elevator bank and exit door.

- **Evacuation:** Exit the building immediately via the stairs. **Do not use elevators.**
- **Assembly Point:** Once outside, proceed to your department's designated **Assembly Point** for a mandatory head count. Do not leave the assembly area until cleared by an Emergency Warden.
- **First Aid:** First aid kits and Automated External Defibrillators (AEDs) are located in the breakroom and near the main reception desk on every floor.

8.4 Drug-Free Workplace

To ensure the safety of our logistics operations and technical accuracy, NJL maintains a strict drug-free workplace.

- **Prohibitions:** The possession, sale, or use of illegal drugs or alcohol during work hours or on company premises is strictly prohibited.

- **Prescription Medication:** Employees taking prescription medication that may impair their ability to perform their duties safely (especially those operating warehouse machinery) must inform their supervisor or HR.
- **Testing:** NJL reserves the right to conduct drug or alcohol testing following any workplace accident that results in injury or significant property damage.

8.5 Workplace Violence Prevention

NJL Enterprises has zero tolerance for workplace violence.

- **Prohibited Behavior:** This includes physical touches, threats, verbal abuse, or the possession of weapons of any kind on company property, including in the parking lot.
- **Reporting:** If you observe behavior that suggests a potential for violence, contact Security immediately or use the **Anonymous Ethics Hotline (1-800-NJL-SAFE)**.

Section 9: Performance Reviews & Development

NJL Enterprises is a high-growth environment. To ensure our team grows alongside the company, we utilize a structured performance management system designed to foster open communication, recognize achievements, and identify areas for professional evolution.

9.1 The Performance Cycle

NJL operates on a bi-annual review cadence. While we encourage managers to provide "real-time" feedback, formal evaluations occur twice a year:

- **Mid-Year Development Check-in (July):** This is a non-rated, growth-focused conversation. The goal is to review progress toward annual goals and adjust resources or training as needed.
- **Annual Performance Review (December):** This is the formal "Review of Record." It involves self-evaluation, manager evaluation, and, in some roles, 360-degree peer feedback. This review determines merit-based salary increases and promotion eligibility.

9.2 Performance Ratings

NJL utilizes a 5-point rating scale to ensure consistency across departments:

1. **Exceptional (5):** Consistently exceeds all goals; demonstrates leadership beyond current role.
2. **Exceeds Expectations (4):** Consistently performs above the required standard.
3. **Meets Expectations (3):** Fully competent; meets all core job requirements and goals.
4. **Inconsistent (2):** Occasionally fails to meet core requirements; requires a Development Plan.
5. **Unsatisfactory (1):** Consistently fails to meet requirements; immediate corrective action required.

9.3 Professional Development Fund

NJL invests in your growth. Every full-time employee is allocated a **Professional Development Stipend of $1,500 per calendar year**.

- **Usage:** This can be used for conferences, certifications, workshops, or professional memberships.
- **Approval:** Expenses must be pre-approved by your manager and submitted via the **Expensify** portal.

9.4 Internal Mobility and Promotions

We prefer to promote from within.

- **Job Postings:** All open positions are posted internally on the **NJL Careers Portal** for seven days before being listed externally.
- **Eligibility:** Employees are generally eligible to apply for internal transfers or promotions after **12 months** in their current role, provided their most recent performance rating was a "3" or higher.

9.5 Performance Improvement Plans (PIP)

If an employee receives an "Inconsistent" or "Unsatisfactory" rating, or if performance significantly declines, they may be placed on a **Performance Improvement Plan (PIP)**.

- **Duration:** Typically 30, 60, or 90 days.
- **Purpose:** To provide clear objectives and support to help the employee return to "Meets Expectations" status.

- **Outcome:** Failure to meet the objectives of a PIP within the designated timeframe may lead to further disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

Section 10: Termination & Resignation

The conclusion of an employment relationship at **NJL Enterprises** is handled with the same level of professionalism and respect as the beginning. This section outlines the procedures for both voluntary and involuntary departures to ensure a smooth transition for both the individual and the company.

10.1 Voluntary Resignation

If you choose to leave NJL Enterprises, we ask for a formal written notice submitted to your direct supervisor and your HR Business Partner.

- **Notice Period:** To ensure business continuity, we request a minimum of **two weeks (10 business days)** notice from all staff.
- **Leadership Roles:** Senior Management (Level 5 and above) and specialized technical leads are requested to provide **four weeks** of notice.
- **Resignation Withdrawal:** Once a resignation is submitted and accepted by HR, it may only be withdrawn with the express written approval of the Department Head.

10.2 Involuntary Termination

NJL Enterprises is an "at-will" employer, meaning either the employee or the company may terminate the relationship at any time, with or without cause.

- **Disciplinary Action:** Except in cases of "Gross Misconduct," NJL typically follows a progressive discipline path (Verbal Warning → Written Warning → PIP → Termination).
- **Gross Misconduct:** Certain actions result in immediate termination without prior warnings. These include, but are not limited to: theft, workplace violence, harassment, or a significant breach of Section 7 (Technology & Security).

10.3 The Offboarding Process

Once a departure date is set, the following steps must be completed:

- **Exit Interview:** HR will schedule a confidential exit interview to gather feedback on your experience at NJL.

- **Return of Property:** All company-issued equipment (laptops, badges, monitors, corporate credit cards) must be returned to the IT Asset Management Team by the end of your last business day.
- **Knowledge Transfer:** Resigning employees are expected to document their current projects and provide a "handoff" briefing to their designated successor or manager.

10.4 Final Compensation

Final pay will be processed in accordance with state and local laws.

- **Final Check:** Typically issued on the next regularly scheduled payday following your last day.
- **PTO Payout:** NJL will pay out accrued but unused Vacation/PTO time up to a **maximum of 80 hours**.
- **Sick Leave:** As noted in Section 6.2, unused sick leave is **not** eligible for payout.
- **Outstanding Debts:** Any outstanding balances for unreturned equipment or unearned relocation advances will be deducted from the final paycheck where legally permitted.

10.5 Post-Employment Obligations

Leaving NJL does not terminate certain legal responsibilities:

- **Confidentiality:** The Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA) signed at hire remains in effect. You may not share trade secrets, client lists, or proprietary logistics algorithms with future employers.
- **Reference Requests:** NJL Enterprises' policy is to provide only "Neutral References" (confirming dates of employment and last job title held) to external third parties.

Section 11: Travel & Expense (T&E) Policy

NJL Enterprises reimburses employees for reasonable and necessary expenses incurred while conducting company business. All travel must be booked through the **NJL Travel Portal (NexTravel)** to ensure corporate rates and automated tracking.

11.1 Air Travel and Lodging

- **Class of Service:** Employees are required to book **Economy Class** for all flights under 6 hours. **Premium Economy** is permitted for international flights exceeding 6 continuous hours of flight time. Business Class requires Executive VP (EVP) approval.

- **Hotel Caps:** NJL observes a maximum nightly lodging rate (excluding taxes) based on location:
    - **Tier 1 Cities (NY, SF, London, Tokyo):** $350/night.
    - **Tier 2 Cities (Chicago, Austin, Berlin):** $250/night.
    - **All other locations:** $175/night.
- **Booking Lead Time:** Flights and hotels should be booked at least **14 days in advance** whenever possible to minimize costs.

11.2 Meals and Incidental Expenses (M&IE)

NJL uses a **Per Diem** (daily allowance) model for meals. Employees do not need to provide receipts for meals if they stay within these daily limits:

- **Daily Per Diem:** $75.00 total.
    - *Suggested breakdown: Breakfast ($15), Lunch ($20), Dinner ($40).*
- **Alcohol:** Alcohol is not a reimbursable expense unless it is part of a pre-approved "Client Entertainment" event.

11.3 Ground Transportation

- **Personal Vehicle:** If using a personal car for business travel, NJL reimburses at the standard IRS mileage rate (currently **$0.67 per mile**). This covers fuel, wear-and-tear, and insurance.
- **Ride-Share:** Uber/Lyft (Standard/X tier) is the preferred method for local travel. Premium or "Black" tiers are not reimbursable.
- **Rental Cars:** Limited to "Mid-size" or "Intermediate" class. GPS and satellite radio add-ons are considered personal expenses and will not be reimbursed.

11.4 Expense Reporting & Reimbursement

1. **Submission:** All expenses must be submitted via the **Expensify** app within **30 days** of the expense being incurred.
2. **Receipts:** Digital copies of receipts are required for any single expense exceeding **$25.00**.
3. **Approval:** Reports are routed to the direct manager for approval. Once approved, reimbursement is processed via direct deposit within **5-7 business days**.

11.5 Non-Reimbursable Items

The following items are considered personal expenses and will **not** be paid for by NJL Enterprises:

- Flight upgrades or lounge memberships.
- Hotel mini-bar items or in-room movies.
- Parking fines or traffic tickets.
- Lost or stolen personal property (luggage, jewelry).